Closing two schools buys one year. There's a brighter path forward.

D65 has a real money problem. Closing two schools barely touches it. Better options do.

THE REAL PROBLEM

D65's costs are growing more than twice as fast as its income.

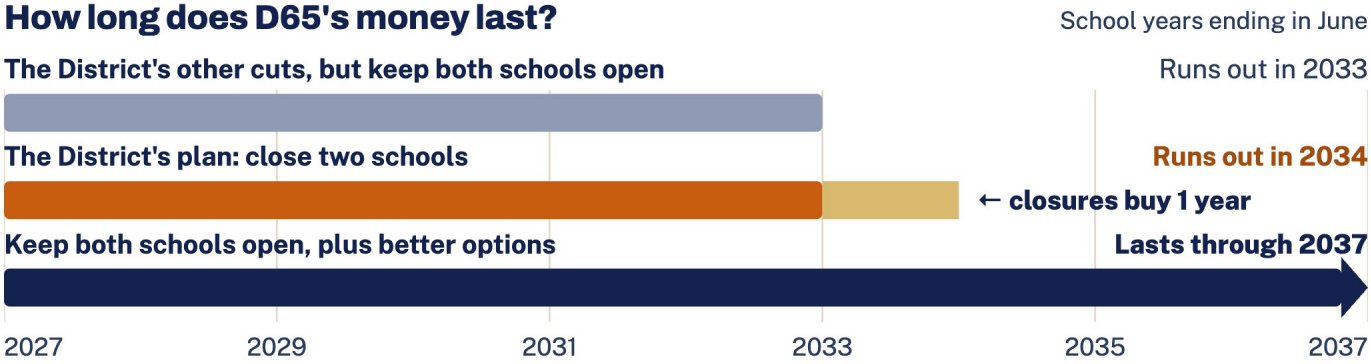
That gap widens every year. Even after the District's $21 million in cuts, the money still runs out. Any real fix has to close that gap.

WHY CLOSING SCHOOLS DOESN'T FIX IT

1% of the budget, about $2.3M a year

- It pushes the shortfall back about one year.
- Kids still need teachers wherever they go.
- Empty buildings still need heat, insurance and repairs.

How long does D65's money last?



Without a new referendum, the better options keep D65 above the board's safety cushion (90 days of cash) for about six years. The District's plan drops below it by 2030.

BETTER OPTIONS

Keep both schools and SACC open, and fix the real problem.

- Keep raises comparable to other local districts
- Slow the growth of benefit costs
- Trim central office staff
- Count the savings that come as staff retire
- Sell the empty Bessie Rhodes and Kingsley buildings
- Use taxes coming back from expiring TIF districts
- **Then, a 2028 referendum voters can trust**

Closing Dewey and Lincolnwood
$2.3M a year

These options by 2032, roughly
$16M a year
plus $9M once from building sales

Tell the board: vote no on Nov. 16. Then let's build a better plan together.

Check our math: see the full spreadsheet at **forabrighterevanston.org**

Source: D65's budget documents and October 2026 plan, corrected for known errors, in the For a Brighter Evanston model.